

ART & CULTURE



INDIAN ARCHITECTURE

MODULE - 12

POST-MAURYAN ART-II

- SCULPTURES
- ROCK-CUT ARCHITECTURE

POST-MAURYAN SCHOOLS OF ART

GANDHARA SCHOOL

VARIOUS MUDRAS OF BUDDHA IN GANDHARA ART

In all, the Buddha depicted in the Gandhara Art is shown making four types of hand gestures and this is a remarkable feature in this art. The gestures are as follows:

1 ABHAYAMUDRA- DON'T FEAR



POST-MAURYAN SCHOOLS OF ART

GANDHARA SCHOOL

VARIOUS MUDRAS OF BUDDHA IN GANDHARA ART

2

DHANYA MUDRA- MEDITATION



The picture shows Buddha in Dhanya Mudra when meditating under the Pipal tree before his Enlightenment

POST-MAURYAN SCHOOLS OF ART

GANDHARA SCHOOL

VARIOUS MUDRAS OF BUDDHA IN GANDHARA ART

3 DHARMACHAKRA MUDRA -A PREACHING MUDRA



- 1 Seated in Dhanyasana with his arms crossed before his chest in the gesture of teaching- Dharmachakra Mudra.
- 2 This Mudra symbolizes one of the most important moments in the life of Buddha, the occasion when he preached to his companions the first sermon after his Enlightenment in the deer park at Sarnath.

POST-MAURYAN SCHOOLS OF ART

GANDHARA SCHOOL

VARIOUS MUDRAS OF BUDDHA IN GANDHARA ART

4 BHUMISPARSHA MUDRA- TOUCHING THE EARTH



1 The Enlightenment: after meditating for forty days beneath a Pipal tree, the Buddha approached the moment of Omniscience.

2 Evil Demons have failed to distract him and he calmly touches the Earth to witness his attainment of Enlightenment.

POST-MAURYAN SCHOOLS OF ART

MATHURA SCHOOL



Yaksha model

- 1** The Mathura School flourished in the banks of the river Yamuna in the period between 1st and 3rd Centuries B.C.
- 2** The sculptures of the Mathura School were influenced by the stories and imageries of all three religions of the time- Buddhism, Hinduism and Jainism.
- 3** The images were modelled on the earlier Yaksha images found during the Mauryan period.
- 4** The Mathura School showed a striking use of symbolism in the images.

POST-MAURYAN SCHOOLS OF ART

MATHURA SCHOOL



Mukhalinga

- 5 The Hindu Gods were represented using their symbols.
- 6 For example, Shiva is shown through Linga and Mukhalinga. Similarly, the halo around the head of Buddha is larger than in Gandhara School and decorated with geometrical patterns.
- 7 Buddha is shown to be surrounded by two Bodhisattavas- Padmapani holding a lotus and Vajrapani holding a thunderbolt.

1. The painting of Bodhisattva Padmapani is one of the most famous and oft-illustrated paintings at(UPSC 2017)

- a) Ajanta
- b) Badami
- c) Bagh
- d) Ellora



Padmapani



Vajrapani

POST-MAURYAN SCHOOLS OF ART

MATHURA SCHOOL

- 8 The Kushans, who came from Central Asia, ruled over vast territories of the north from the 1st to the 3rd century A.D.
- 9 During their regime, Mathura, just 80 miles away from Delhi, was throbbing with great artistic activity, and its workshops even catered to the outside demands for sculpture.
- 10 Now icons of Brahmanical gods and goddesses and Buddhist and Jain divinities, which characterized the subsequent evolution of Indian art were produced experimentally.
- 11 Some magnificent works of the Kushan emperors were executed during the period in the characteristic red and red-speckled sandstone of Mathura i.e. Buff colored sandstone.

POST-MAURYAN SCHOOLS OF ART

MATHURA SCHOOL



Avalokiteshwara

12 The Buddhist religion greatly flourished under the patronage of Kushan emperors, and in the Mathura school several images of the Buddha and Bodhisattavas were produced after the earlier Yaksha types.

13 Here, we may point out the difference between a Buddha and Bodhisattava. Buddha is one who has attained the enlightenment of supreme knowledge, while the Bodhisattava is still a candidate for it.

POST-MAURYAN SCHOOLS OF ART

MATHURA SCHOOL



- 14 Specific Mathura adaptations tend to reflect warmer climatic conditions, as they consist in a higher fluidity of the clothing, which progressively tend to cover only one shoulder instead of both.
- 15 Also, facial types also tend to become more Indianized.
- 16 The art of Mathura features frequent sexual imagery. Female images with frontal nudity and displaying female genitals are common.

POST-MAURYAN SCHOOLS OF ART

MATHURA SCHOOL

17 Incidentally, Hindu art and imagery of Hindu gods started to develop a definitive structure from the Mathura Art.

18 It progressively incorporated a profusion of original Hindu stylistic and symbolic elements, in contrast with the general balance and simplicity of Buddhist art.

19 Thus, the forms of Brahmanical deities became crystallised at Mathura for the first time.

20 Folklores such as the Jatakas were drawn out in long panels on rock faces.

21 Besides the images of Buddha and Hindu gods, statues of Mahavira were also produced.

POST-MAURYAN SCHOOLS OF ART

RELATIONSHIP TO GANDHARA STYLE

- 1** The Mathura and Gandhāra styles strongly influenced each other. During their artistic florescence, the two regions were united politically under the Kushans.
- 2** It is still a matter of debate whether the anthropomorphic representations of Buddha were essentially a result of a local evolution of Buddhist art at Mathura, or a consequence of Greek cultural influence in Gandhāra through the Greco-Buddhist syncretism .
- 3** This iconic art was characterized from the start by a realistic idealism that combined realistic human features, proportions, attitudes, and attributes, together with a sense of perfection and serenity reaching to the divine.
- 4** This expression of the Buddha as both man and God became the iconographic canon for subsequent Buddhist art. Thus, we can say that Buddha in the symbolic form got a human form in Mathura and Gandhara.

POST-MAURYAN SCHOOLS OF ART

FAMOUS EXAMPLES OF MATHURA ART

1 SEATED BUDDHA, KATRA MOUND



- 1 A large number of images dating back to the Kushana Period is from Mathura.
- 2 The seated Buddha belongs to the second century CE.
- 3 It represents the Buddha with two Bodhisattva attendants identified as Padmapani and Vajrapani as one holds a lotus and the other a vajra (thunderbolt). They wear crowns and are on either side of the Buddha.

POST-MAURYAN SCHOOLS OF ART

FAMOUS EXAMPLES OF MATHURA ART

1

SEATED BUDDHA, KATRA MOUND



4 The Buddha is seated in **padmasana** (**cross-folded legs**) and the right hand is in the **abhayamudra**, raised a little above the shoulder level whereas the left hand is placed on the left thigh.

5 The **ushanisha**, i.e., **hair knot**, is shown with a vertically raised projection.

6 Mathura sculptures from this period are made with light volume **having fleshy body**.

POST-MAURYAN SCHOOLS OF ART

FAMOUS EXAMPLES OF MATHURA ART

1

SEATED BUDDHA, KATRA MOUND



7

The shoulders are broad.

8

The sanghati (garment) covers only one shoulder and has been made prominently visible covering the left hand whereas while covering the torso, the independent volume of the garment is reduced to the body torso.

9

The Buddha is seated on a lion throne.

10

The halo around the head of the Buddha is very large and is decorated with simple geometric motifs.

POST-MAURYAN SCHOOLS OF ART

FAMOUS EXAMPLES OF MATHURA ART

1 SEATED BUDDHA, KATRA MOUND

11 There are two flying figures placed diagonally above the halo.

12 They bear a lot of movement in the picture space. Flexibility replaces the earlier rigidity in the images giving them a more earthy look.

13 Curves of the body are as delicately carved.

14 The face is round with fleshy cheeks. The bulge of the belly is sculpted with controlled musculature.

15 It may be noted that there are numerous examples of sculptures from the Kushana Period at Mathura, but this image is representative and is important for the understanding of the development of the Buddha image in the subsequent periods.

POST-MAURYAN SCHOOLS OF ART

FAMOUS EXAMPLES OF MATHURA ART

2 HEADLESS KANISHKA



3 SARVATOBHADRA JAIN



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